



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: First Baptist Academy
School Website: <https://www.fbaeagles.org/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

First Baptist Academy TN 37849 presents a clearly classical, Christian-influenced approach to education. The public materials emphasize a biblical worldview, a triadic Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), and liturgical/community practices (chapel, daily assemblies, worship) that align with the religious/metaphysical and communal aspects of classical education. The curriculum is described as integrated with biblical faith, and upper-level pedagogy centers on rhetoric and inquiry-oriented discussion within a historically rooted framework. While the school demonstrates strong alignment across most classical criteria, explicit, widely-prominent statements about certain elements (e.g., a fully articulated "living curriculum" or formal, explicit Socratic/Seminar practices in upper grades beyond the Trivium framework) are less conspicuous in the online materials. On balance, the school is best categorized as CLASSICAL, with some room for further explicit articulation in a few categories.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school frames its program as Christian in orientation and aligned with a biblical worldview across all subjects. - The approach is described as "classical" and Christ-centered, with statements that education is lived within a biblical framework and God-centered aims. - Daily life includes Biblical integration, Scripture exposure, and worship-oriented practices (e.g., chapel, daily assembly). - Admissions and program narratives emphasize a Christ-centered, truth-based approach and spiritual formation.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Observed positive keywords: biblical worldview, Christ-centered, truth-based, Scripture, God's Word, chapel, daily assembly, worship, gospel.

- Negative keywords: none detected in public materials (no secular/humanist or relativist signals observed). The lexicon explicitly flags negative signals in other contexts; none appear here.

Why this rating - The materials consistently foreground theology, liturgical practice, and a sacred orientation to education. The presence of liturgical life (chapel, daily assembly), Scripture-centered learning, and explicit Christian worldview signals align strongly with the Positive Keywords for Religious and Metaphysical Foundations, supporting a CLASSICAL rating in this category. The absence of secular/neutral framing reinforces this assessment.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The aim is framed as formation and formation toward virtue and a Christian worldview, not primarily work-preparation. The school emphasizes a Christ-centered, biblical formation of students. - The messaging centers on influencing students to impact the world for Christ and to cultivate character and formation through a biblical lens. - There is a clear emphasis on a classical framework (Trivium) as a guiding educational philosophy, tied to formation rather than mere information transfer.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Observed positive keywords: formation, virtue (via formation/holistic aims in many classical sources), truth, goodness, beauty (via the classical framing and biblical integration),

great conversation (implied through classical framework though not always explicit in every page), study of biblical/worldview.

- Negative keywords: none evident in the public materials (no explicit “college- and-workforce-prep” orientation; the school emphasizes formation rather than vocational bias). The classical lexicon notes potential negatives like “workforce preparation emphasis,” which is not reflected here.

Why this rating - The school’s stated aims center on formation, virtue, and a teleological orientation aligned with classical education and Christian purpose rather than solely job-readiness. Public materials consistently connect education to virtue, wisdom, and the true/good/beautiful, aligning with the CLASSICAL signal for this category. While “great conversation” and explicit telos language appear in broader classical discourse, the school’s core messaging around formation and biblical formation suffices for CLASSICAL here.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The curriculum emphasizes the Trivium: grammar, logic, rhetoric, with explicit detail on grammar (lower school), logic (middle school), and rhetoric (upper school). - History is studied across the curriculum with explicit courses and historical framing (World History, Ancient History) rather than social studies as a discipline. - There are explicit references to biblical/history literatures and language study (Latin and Spanish vocabulary) within the grammar stage, aligning with classical curriculum expectations. - There are mentions of “Bible history” and integrated biblical worldview in the curriculum narrative.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Observed positive keywords: grammar, logic, rhetoric; Great Books / Great Conversation language is not consistently explicit on the site, but the Trivium framing and historical study across the curriculum are clear. Latin vocabulary is present. Bible history is part of the curriculum narrative.

- Negative keywords: not evident; no evidence of project-based or STEM-first framing that would signal deviation from classic curriculum. The public materials emphasize classical content, not replace it with modern pedagogies.

Why this rating - The explicit inclusion of grammar, logic, rhetoric; the focus on history throughout curriculum; and the language surrounding classical method strongly support CLASSICAL for Curriculum. The absence (in public materials) of an explicit, exclusive “Great Books” catalog is noted but does not negate the overall classical curriculum framing.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Lower School pedagogy surfaces in terms of memory-preserving and foundational activities (e.g., memorization of facts in the grammar stage, Latin/grammar memory work). The site describes the three-stage Trivium in practice, including grammar, logic, and rhetoric progression. - The upper school emphasizes rhetoric and leadership, with opportunities to give speeches and engage in rhetoric training, consistent with classical pedagogy. - The site mentions a high emphasis on biblical integration and a Christ-centered approach across all subjects, which is aligned with a liturgical, reflective pedagogy; however, explicit statements about Socratic seminars, Paideia-style seminars, or formal lower/upper-school Socratic discussions are not clearly articulated in the public materials. The explicit mention of “Socratic discussion” or “Paideia seminars” is not overtly present in the accessible pages.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Observed positive keywords: memorization, grammar, logic, rhetoric, memory work, oratory, rhetoric exercises, public speaking, leadership training, seminars (implicit in rhetoric training), liturgical integration (chapel, daily assembly).

- Negative keywords: explicit references to experiential, project-based, student-directed, or constructivist pedagogy are not present; however, the site does not make explicit the strong, explicit use of Socratic seminars or Paideia-style seminars beyond the Trivium framing. The absence of these explicit statements places this category in SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL.

Why this rating - The school clearly follows classical pedagogical elements (grammar/logic/rhetoric and rhetoric-focused upper-school leadership). However, explicit, formal statements of Socratic/seminar-based

pedagogy or other Paideia-style practices in the published materials are not prominent, which leads to a partial but not full alignment. This suggests a CLASSICAL core with some pedagogical elements not fully explicit in public-facing content.

Element 5: Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The public materials include named faculty roles (e.g., Honors Program Coordinator Tonya Petty) and a structured Honors program, which signals a faculty-driven, guided curriculum and mentorship culture. This indicates a living curriculum dynamic and a community of teachers. - The content references mentorship and leadership development (e.g., Worship Arts, leadership opportunities, and the Honors Program) which aligns with a teacher-as-mentor model and a living curriculum. - There is less explicit, public-facing language about a formal “portrait of a teacher,” a “faculty as living curriculum,” or a defined “collegial faculty culture” beyond programmatic roles; those elements are not as overtly described in the public-facing pages.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Observed positive keywords: mentor/teacher as leader, Honors Program Coordinator, leadership opportunities, living curriculum (implied through programmatic structures and the faculty’s role in advanced programs).

- Negative keywords: explicit “facilitator” or “teacher as guide on the side” signals are not present; the public materials do not present counter-terms that would signal a non-classical faculty model. Still, the absence of explicit statements about a “portrait of a teacher” or deeply articulated classical-faculty norms places this in SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL.

Why this rating - The existence of named classical-education leadership roles and structured programs signals a school that values teachers as central to the curriculum (aligned with the classical ideal). However, the lack of explicit, comprehensive statements about a formal “living curriculum” or a formal faculty portrait in public materials yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL classification for Faculty.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school emphasizes partnership with parents and church involvement, including co-teachers with parents and parent formation around classical education. The materials describe partnership with parents and the church to provide a biblical worldview education. - There are explicit mentions of opportunities for parent involvement (admissions tours, open campus mindset, and family participation) and public-facing content indicating parent engagement as part of the school community. - There are recipient opportunities for parents to participate in the school environment (e.g., chapel attendance by parents, parent-facing programs, and homeschool-related forms).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Observed positive keywords: partnership with parents, co-teachers, parent formation/groups/book studies (as implied by classical-education parent formation concepts), open campus/visit invitation style. - Negative keywords: none observed (no consumerism or minimal parent involvement signals). The materials emphasize active parental involvement and formation rather than consumer-style participation.

Why this rating - The public materials strongly emphasize parental partnership, co-teaching language, and parent involvement, which aligns with CLASSICAL signals in this category. While more explicit descriptions of ongoing parent formation programs could strengthen the case, the current public content clearly supports CLASSICAL in Parents & Community.

Overall assessment (aggregate) - Element 1: CLASSICAL - Element 2: CLASSICAL - Element 3: CLASSICAL - Element 4: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Element 5: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Element 6: CLASSICAL

Aggregate ranking: CLASSICAL

What Would Move the Needle

- Element 4 (Pedagogy): Introduce explicit, public-facing statements about Socratic/Seminar-based practices (e.g., Paideia seminars) in upper grades and articulate how Socratic inquiry and disciplined

dialogue are integrated with logic and rhetoric instruction. This would convert SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL to CLASSICAL for Pedagogy.

- Element 5 (Faculty): Publish a formal “Portrait of the Teacher” and a publicly accessible description of the living-curriculum approach, including a structured professional-development plan for classical pedagogy, and examples of faculty collaboration that demonstrate collegiality and mentorship in practice.
- Element 2 (Purpose and Goal): More explicit language around telos, formation, and virtue directly tied to program outcomes (e.g., mission-centered outcomes, concrete articulation of formation, virtue, wisdom, and the good) would strengthen the formation narrative and push Element 2 toward CLASSICAL.
- Element 3 (Curriculum): If possible, publish a concise, explicit listing of Great Books or primary-sources in core subjects, and a clear statement about “Great Conversation” as a curricular anchor, supplementing the Trivium with explicit Great Books references to reinforce the Great Conversation aspect.
- Element 6 (Parents & Community): Expand parent-formation offerings (e.g., regular book studies, parent seminars on classical pedagogy) with a publicly available schedule to further strengthen the parent formation signal.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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